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Caring for Yourself

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Hartman

1. Describe how to find a job

NAs seeking work can locate potential employers using these resources:

- Internet
- Job websites
- Google
- Local newspaper's website
- Classified ads
- Instructors and their employers and personal contacts

1. Describe how to find a job

Think about these questions:

Do you know of any other resources for finding jobs?

How did you hear about this NA course?

1. Describe how to find a job

When applying for a job it is important to have the following documents on hand:

- Identification such as driver's license, social security card, birth certificate, or passport
- Proof of legal ability to work in this country
- Credentials such as school diplomas (course completion/graduation certificates, NA certification, other certification), including the names of instructors
- Letters of reference from former employers or teachers, not family or friends

1. Describe how to find a job

A résumé should include

- Contact details
- Educational experience, starting with most recent
- Work experience, starting with most recent
- Special skills
- Memberships in professional organizations
- Volunteer work

1. Describe how to find a job

The following general information is needed for a job application:

- Your address, phone number, and email address
- Birth date and social security number
- Training school and dates, certification numbers
- Previous employers' names, addresses, phone numbers, and email addresses; and dates of employment
- Salary information from previous jobs
- Reasons why you left former jobs
- References, including phone numbers and email addresses
- Availability (days and hours)
- Brief statement about why you are changing jobs

1. Describe how to find a job

REMEMBER:

It is essential to be honest when completing job applications, even if that means including negative information like a criminal history. Not doing so may be considered fraud.

A criminal background check will be completed before an NA is hired.

Neatness and appearance and paperwork will be considered in the hiring process. It is important to make an effort to look professional and to fill out all forms carefully and legibly.

Handout 10-1: Job Application

Employment Application	
Personal Information	
Name:	Date:
Home Address:	
City, State, Zip:	
Email Address:	
Home Phone:	Business Phone:
US Citizen?	If not, give visa number and expiration date:
Position Applying For	
Title:	Salary Desired:
Referred By:	Date Available:
Education	
High School (Name, City, State):	
Graduation Date:	
Technical or Undergraduate School:	
Dates Attended:	Degree Major:
References	

1. Describe how to find a job

These tips will help a candidate make a good impression at a job interview:

- Shower or bathe and use deodorant.
- Brush your teeth.
- Wash your hands. Clean and file your nails. Do not wear artificial nails.
- Wear only simple makeup and jewelry or none at all.
- Style clean hair simply.
- Shave or trim facial hair before interview.
- Dress neatly and appropriately.
- Do not wear perfume or cologne.

1. Describe how to find a job

Tips for making a good impression at a job interview (cont'd):

- Do not smoke beforehand.
- Arrive 10 or 15 minutes early.
- Do not bring friends or children with you.
- Turn off your phone.
- Introduce yourself.
- Answer questions clearly and completely.
- Make eye contact.
- Avoid slang expressions
- Never eat, drink, chew gum, or smoke.
- Sit up or stand up straight.
- Relax and be confident.

2. Describe a standard job description and explain how to manage time and assignments

It is important to know these points about job descriptions:

- Agreement between employer and employee
- States responsibilities and tasks
- Includes skills required, to whom employee reports, salary
- Protects both parties
- Protects employee from change in duties without notification
- Protects employee from being fired for something unrelated to job description
- Protects employer from employee saying she did not know certain duties were required
- Reduces misunderstandings
- Can be used if legal issues arise

2. Describe a standard job description and explain how to manage time and assignments

REMEMBER:

When taking care of residents, NAs must be able to manage time well. Managing time properly ensures all tasks can be completed during a shift.

In order to manage time properly an NA must

- Plan ahead.
- Prioritize.
- Make a schedule.
- Combine activities.
- Get help when needed.

2. Describe a standard job description and explain how to manage time and assignments

Think about these questions:

When might an NA need to get help?

Where can an NA find help if she needs it?

3. Discuss how to manage and resolve conflict

REMEMBER:

Everyone experiences conflict at some point, but conflict at work may harm productivity and the workplace environment if it is not managed or resolved.

3. Discuss how to manage and resolve conflict

Think about this question:

What impact do you think unresolved workplace conflict might have on the quality of care that residents receive?

3. Discuss how to manage and resolve conflict

NAs should remember these guidelines for resolving conflict:

- Plan to discuss at the right time and in the right place.
- Do not interrupt.
- Do not get emotional.
- Check body language.
- Keep focus on the issue at hand.
- Be prepared to brainstorm solutions and to compromise.

4. Describe employee evaluations and discuss appropriate responses to criticism

REMEMBER:

There is a difference between hostile criticism, which is angry and negative, and constructive criticism, which is meant to help a person improve. The best response to hostile criticism is something like, “I’m sorry you are so disappointed” and nothing more.

4. Describe employee evaluations and discuss appropriate responses to criticism

To get the most out of constructive criticism

- Ask for details.
- Ask for suggestions.
- Apologize and move on.

4. Describe employee evaluations and discuss appropriate responses to criticism

REMEMBER:

Evaluations are often the basis for advancement and salary increases. It is helpful for NAs to be open to constructive criticism and to use their employers' suggestions for improvement.

4. Describe employee evaluations and discuss appropriate responses to criticism

REMEMBER:

It is very important to give at least two weeks' written notice before leaving a job. Both residents and staff will suffer if the facility is understaffed, and leaving without proper notice will make it more difficult to get hired in the future.

5. Discuss certification and explain the state's registry

NAs should remember these guidelines regarding certification:

- OBRA requires 75 hours of initial training and 12 annual hours of continuing education
- There is a set time frame during which the state test must be taken or the NA will have to take a new training course.
- NA must work for pay within first 24 months.
- NA usually has three chances to pass test
- NA must keep certification current.

5. Discuss certification and explain the state's registry

Important facts about state registries:

- Required by OBRA
- Often maintained by state's Board of Nursing or Department of Health
- Contains NA's training information, results of exams, and any findings of abuse, neglect or theft
- Employers can access to verify certification and check for abuse investigations/findings.

6. Describe continuing education

REMEMBER:

The government requires that NAs receive 12 hours of continuing education every year.

NAs have the following areas of responsibility when receiving continuing education:

- Sign up and know the location.
- Attend class.
- Pay attention and complete requirements.
- Participate.
- Keep records of attendance.

7. Explain ways to manage stress

Define the following terms:

stress

the state of being frightened, excited, confused, in danger, or irritated.

stressor

something that causes stress.

7. Explain ways to manage stress

REMEMBER:

It is not just negative events/situations that can cause stress. Positive events/situations such as a wedding or a new baby's arrival can also cause stress from the changes they bring to a person's life.

7. Explain ways to manage stress

Think about this question:

Look at the stressors listed on page 247. Can you think of any other possible stressors?

7. Explain ways to manage stress

NAs should remember these guidelines for managing stress:

- Healthy diet
- Exercise
- Enough sleep
- Drinking in moderation
- Not smoking
- Doing something relaxing (bath, reading, movie, being in nature, something artistic, yoga, exercise, massage, music, meditation)

7. Explain ways to manage stress

When stress is not managed, possible problems include

- Showing anger or being abusive toward residents
- Arguing with your supervisor
- Having poor relationships with coworkers and residents
- Complaining about your job and your responsibilities
- Feeling work-related burnout
- Feeling tired even when you are rested
- Having a difficult time focusing

7. Explain ways to manage stress

The following are appropriate sources for managing stress:

- Supervisor/care team member
- Family
- Friends
- Support group
- Place of worship
- Doctor
- Mental health agency
- Phone hotline

7. Explain ways to manage stress

REMEMBER:

NAs must not discuss their stress with residents or with residents' friends or family members.

7. Explain ways to manage stress

Think about these questions:

Why did you choose to become an NA?

What does it mean to you to be able to help others?

How will you remind yourself of how valuable your work is?



Hartman